

Step 1: Release the Camera from Other Applications

Webcams can usually only be streamed by **one application at a time**. If another app is actively utilizing the webcam in the background, Zoom will be blocked from accessing it.

1. **Close the default Camera app** you just used to test the video.
2. Completely close out of any other software that might use your camera (e.g., Microsoft Teams, Skype, Discord, OBS, or browser tabs running Google Meet).
3. Relaunch Zoom and check the video.

Step 2: Check Windows Privacy Permissions

Windows has dedicated privacy toggles that can block desktop applications like Zoom from accessing your hardware, even if Microsoft's built-in apps work fine.

1. Open Privacy Settings:

Click the **Start Menu**, open **Settings**, and select **Privacy & security** from the left sidebar.

2. Navigate to Camera Permissions:

Scroll down under the *App permissions* section and click on **Camera**.

3. Enable Global Access:

Ensure that **Camera access** is toggled **On**, and **Let apps access your camera** is also toggled **On**.

4. Allow Desktop Apps:

Scroll further down the page to find **Let desktop apps access your camera**. Ensure this switch is turned **On**. *Note: Zoom is classified as a desktop app, so this specific toggle must be active.*

Step 3: Verify Device Selection Inside Zoom

If the camera is free and permissions are granted, Zoom might simply be trying to pull video from the wrong source (like an old integrated webcam or a virtual camera driver).

1. Open the Zoom app and click the **settings** (gear icon) in the top-right corner.
2. Click on the **Video** tab in the left-hand menu.
3. Look at the **Camera** dropdown menu. If it says "Integrated Camera" or a virtual source like "OBS Virtual Camera," click it and switch it to your newly connected **USB Webcam**.

Step 4: Confirm Resolution

- Once you select the correct USB webcam in the dropdown, the live video preview box inside Zoom should instantly light up.

- Join your next meeting and click the arrow next to **Start Video** to ensure your external USB camera has a checkmark next to it.